

"Working with Partners": A Strategic Guide to Using WhatsApp

How to use WhatsApp to communicate professionally, set boundaries, and manage creative projects with high-value clients.

1. Establish the Professional Boundary (The "Partner" Setup)

To be treated as a strategic partner, your WhatsApp environment must look professional. Avoid using a chaotic personal account for high-ticket client interactions.

- **Consider WhatsApp Business:** If possible, download the separate **WhatsApp Business app**. It allows you to set up a professional profile containing your work hours, email, and portfolio link, immediately signaling that you run a structured operation.
- **Professional Identity Check:** Ensure your profile photo is a clean, professional headshot or a sleek brand logo. Your "About" status should state exactly what you execute (e.g., *"Optimizing video content for high-impact brand growth"*).
- **Set the Schedule:** Use the *Away Messages* or *Greeting* tools in the Business app to let clients know your working hours. If they message you at 10:00 PM, an automated response should politely let them know you will **execute** a review first thing in the morning.

2. High-Value Communication Habits

When a client sends a message, don't just react as a task-taker. Use strategic messaging frameworks to guide the conversation.

- **The "Batching" Rule:** Never send 10 consecutive, single-sentence messages. It clutters your partner's feed and feels chaotic. Instead, compile your ideas, script adjustments, or questions into a single, beautifully structured message using bold headers and bullet points.
- **Upgrade Your Vocabulary:** The way you phrase your updates completely shifts your perceived value:
 - *Instead of:* "Can you help me see if this rough cut looks okay?"
 - *Say:* **"Let's collaborate on this visual direction. I have illustrated the core changes in this cut to optimize viewer retention."**
 - *Instead of:* "I am planning out the videos for next week, what do you want me to do?"

- Say: "I have mapped out our video layout strategy for next week. Let's connect briefly to strategize how we will execute the upcoming narrative hooks."

3. Workflow & Asset Management for Video Creators

WhatsApp is a great tool for fast-paced creative reviews if you structure your assets correctly.

- **Preserve Visual Quality (Send as Document):** When sharing raw visual layouts, asset hooks, or video drafts for quick review, never send them as a standard video message—WhatsApp will heavily compress and degrade the quality. Instead, tap the plus/paperclip icon, select **Document**, and choose the file. This sends the uncompressed, high-fidelity file perfectly intact.
- **Pin Strategic Priorities:** You can pin up to 3 chats to the very top of your feed. Keep your active client project channels or your own "**Message Yourself**" notes chat pinned so critical creative data is never lost beneath general social notifications.
- **Star Critical Insights:** When a partner gives specific feedback on pacing, video targets, or metric goals, long-press that exact message and tap the **Star icon**. You can view all your starred messages globally in your settings later, giving you an instant repository of client directions without scrolling through weeks of chat history.

4. Client Collaboration Etiquette (Group Chats)

When managing a project inside a shared team group chat, maintain absolute clarity and structure.

- **The Threaded Reply:** In active group chats, text moves fast. Always long-press and reply directly to the specific comment or metric feedback you are addressing so the team knows exactly which task or scene edit you are referencing.
- **Voice Note Etiquette:** Voice notes are phenomenal for explaining complex narrative arcs, but keep them professional. Keep them under 90 seconds, speak clearly, and preface the voice note with a quick one-line text summary (e.g., "*Dropping a quick voice note outlining how we will optimize the first 3 seconds of the hook*").
- **Actionable Closing:** Never end a project update open-ended. Always close with a clear timeline of what you will execute next, solidifying your role as the driving creative force behind the campaign.